

THE VETERAN REBUILD CHECKLIST — Lead Magnet

SECTION 1: OPT-IN PAGE COPY

HEADLINE

The Veteran Rebuild Checklist

80 Questions That Will Tell You Exactly Where Your Transition Stands — And What to Do Next

SUBHEADLINE

You don't need another motivational speech. You need a clear-eyed assessment of where you are, what's working, what's broken, and what to fix first. This is it. Free. Built for veterans who are done drifting.

WHAT'S INSIDE

Download the free checklist and get an honest accounting of your transition across every major area of life:

- **Identity** — Do you know who you are without the uniform? Have you answered the question, or just avoided it?
- **Discipline and Structure** — Are you running your day, or is your day running you?
- **Financial Baseline** — Do you know your actual numbers? Are you leaving VA benefits on the table?
- **Career Transition** — Is your resume doing work for you, or working against you?
- **Mental Resilience** — Are you sleeping? Moving? Connected to something? Or are you just functioning?
- **VA Benefits** — Have you enrolled, filed, appealed, and applied for every benefit you earned?
- **Relationships** — Who's in your corner? What relationships need repair? What do you owe?
- **Ownership Mindset** — Are you building a life, or just surviving until something changes?

80 items across 8 areas of veteran life. Not a quiz with a score. A real, field-level assessment with action items attached. You'll finish this document knowing exactly where you stand — and what to do in the next 30 days.

It's free. It takes 20 minutes. And it might be the most honest conversation you've had with yourself since you got out.

BUTTON COPY OPTIONS

Primary: Download the Free Checklist — Start the Rebuild

Alternative A: Get Instant Access — Free for Veterans

Alternative B: Send Me the Checklist — I'm Ready to Be Honest

SECTION 2: THE VETERAN REBUILD CHECKLIST

Print this. Use a pen. Don't think too long on any item — your first instinct is usually the right one.

Marking system:

- **[X]** = Done. Solid. This area is handled.
- **[~]** = Partially done or in progress. There's more work here.
- **[]** = Not done. This is a gap. Priority action required.

AREA 1: IDENTITY CHECKLIST

Who are you without the uniform? This is the question most veterans avoid — and the one that underlies every other challenge in transition.

1. [] I can describe who I am without using my rank, branch, MOS, or unit as the primary descriptor.
 2. [] I have written down (not just thought about) my top 5 personal values — the principles I actually live by, not the ones I think sound good.
 3. [] I know the difference between my military identity (role, function, position) and my core identity (who I am as a human being). I can explain that difference out loud.
 4. [] I have identified at least 3 skills or strengths that exist independent of the military — things I would have been good at regardless of whether I served.
 5. [] When I introduce myself in civilian settings, I feel like my introduction accurately represents who I am — not like I'm hiding something or overselling something.
 6. [] I have allowed myself to grieve the loss of my military identity — intentionally, not just by suppressing it. I know what I'm mourning and I've named it.
 7. [] I have a written "operator's manual" or personal statement — something that describes my values, my strengths, the way I work best, and what I'm building toward.
 8. [] I am not primarily defining myself by what I used to do. I have a forward-looking identity that is mine, not borrowed from my service record.
 9. [] I have at least one community or context outside the military and veterans' world where I feel genuinely myself and genuinely valued.
 10. [] I have asked — and begun to honestly answer — the question: "What do I want my life to mean in 10 years?" Not what do I want to achieve. What do I want it to mean.
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AREA 2: DISCIPLINE AND STRUCTURE CHECKLIST

The military gave you structure from the outside. Civilian life requires you to build it from the inside. How's that going?

1. [] I have a consistent morning routine — not a perfect one, not a 5am miracle routine — a real, repeatable sequence that starts my day with intention instead of chaos.
 2. [] I have a weekly planning practice. Once a week, I sit down and look at the upcoming week — commitments, priorities, gaps. I'm not winging it day to day.
 3. [] I know my top 3 priorities for this week. Right now. Without having to think about it for more than 10 seconds.
 4. [] I use a system — calendar, task manager, notebook, something — to track what I need to do. My obligations are not all living in my head.
 5. [] I have a consistent sleep schedule. I go to bed and wake up at roughly the same time most days. I'm not sleeping until noon on weekends and lying awake at 0300 on weekdays.
 6. [] I exercise consistently — not perfectly, not at peak military fitness levels, but consistently. At least 3 times per week, most weeks.
 7. [] I have a process for reviewing how the week went — what worked, what didn't, what I need to adjust. I'm iterating on my own systems.
 8. [] I am not primarily reactive. I am not spending most of my time responding to whatever comes at me. I have protected time for the things that matter most.
 9. [] I have identified my peak performance hours — the time of day when I do my best thinking and hardest work — and I protect those hours.
 10. [] My environment supports my discipline. My phone, my physical space, my daily commitments, and my social environment are more likely to push me toward my goals than away from them.
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AREA 3: FINANCIAL BASELINE CHECKLIST

You cannot build on a foundation you haven't measured. This section is about knowing your numbers — all of them.

1. [] I know my exact monthly take-home income — all sources combined (employment, VA compensation, GI Bill housing allowance, rental income, spouse income, etc.).
2. [] I know my exact monthly fixed expenses — rent/mortgage, car payment, insurance, subscriptions, loan minimums. I could write the number right now without having to log into anything.

3. [] I track my variable spending. I know roughly what I spend on food, entertainment, clothing, and miscellaneous each month. This is not a guess — it's a number I can verify.
 4. [] I have a written budget. Not a mental budget. A written-down, category-level plan for where my money goes each month. It may not be perfect, but it exists.
 5. [] I have an emergency fund. At minimum, 1 month of expenses in a separate savings account that I do not touch. (Goal is 3–6 months, but 1 month is the floor.)
 6. [] I know my net worth. Assets minus liabilities. I have calculated this number within the last 6 months. I know whether it went up or down.
 7. [] I have no credit card debt that is older than 6 months. If I have credit card debt, I have a written plan to eliminate it with a specific payoff timeline.
 8. [] I have contributed to a retirement or investment account in the last 12 months — even a small amount. The Thrift Savings Plan, a Roth IRA, or an employer 401k.
 9. [] I have reviewed my credit report within the last 12 months. I know my score and I know what's on my report. (AnnualCreditReport.com is free.)
 10. [] I have a 90-day financial goal that I am actively working toward. Not a vague wish — a specific, written goal with a dollar amount and a deadline.
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AREA 4: CAREER TRANSITION CHECKLIST

Your military career is an asset — but only if you know how to deploy it in civilian markets. This section assesses your career readiness.

1. [] I have a civilian resume — not a military resume converted to Times New Roman, but a document written in civilian language that accurately represents my experience and gets responses from civilian employers.
2. [] My LinkedIn profile is complete: professional photo, clear headline (not just my job title), a summary written in first person that tells my story, detailed work history, and at least 5 skills listed.
3. [] I have identified my target role or roles — the specific job titles I'm going for, the industries I'm targeting, and the companies or organizations on my list. I am not applying to everything.
4. [] I have researched the salary range for my target role in my target geography. I know what I'm worth in this market and I can name a number when asked.

5. [] I have had at least 3 informational conversations in the last 90 days with people who are in roles or industries I'm targeting. Not job interviews — conversations.
 6. [] I can answer "Tell me about yourself" in 60–90 seconds in a way that is compelling, relevant, and does not begin with "I was in the Army for [X] years."
 7. [] I can translate my most significant military accomplishment into civilian language — without acronyms, without rank structure, without assumed context — in under 2 minutes.
 8. [] I have at least 3 people who can provide a professional reference and who are prepared to do so. I have confirmed their willingness in the last 6 months.
 9. [] If I am in school on the GI Bill, I have a plan for what I am building toward with this degree — specific roles, specific outcomes, not just "I'm getting a degree."
 10. [] I know what I will do next if my current career path doesn't work out. I have a Plan B that is realistic and that I have thought through, not just named.
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AREA 5: MENTAL RESILIENCE CHECKLIST

This is not a mental health diagnostic. This is a practical assessment of the habits and systems that support your ability to function, adapt, and keep moving forward.

1. [] I am sleeping 7–8 hours most nights. If I'm not, I have identified why and I'm actively working on it — not just accepting it as normal.
2. [] I move my body with some form of intentional exercise at least 3 times per week. Not because of appearance — because I know what happens to my mood and cognition when I don't move.
3. [] I have at least one person I can be completely honest with about how I'm actually doing — not a social answer, not "I'm fine." Someone who gets the real version.
4. [] I have an outlet for stress that is not alcohol, isolation, or substances. Physical exertion, creative practice, journaling, talking — something that actually processes stress rather than suppresses it.
5. [] I am honest with myself about my relationship with alcohol. I know how much I drink, I know whether it has increased since separation, and I am not lying to myself about the pattern.
6. [] If I am experiencing symptoms of PTSD, anxiety, depression, or TBI — I am getting support. Not suffering in silence. Not self-medicating. Getting actual support.

7. ☐ I have a recovery practice — something that recharges me after hard or draining days. I know what it is, and I use it deliberately rather than just collapsing.
 8. ☐ I am engaged with something that gives me a sense of meaning or contribution. Not just a job — something I care about. It doesn't have to be big.
 9. ☐ I have a relationship with my own anger. I know what triggers me, I know how I tend to respond, and I have strategies for managing high-activation states that don't damage the people around me.
 10. ☐ I check in with myself deliberately — not just in crisis. I have some form of regular self-assessment practice (journaling, weekly review, therapy) that lets me catch problems before they become crises.
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AREA 6: VA BENEFITS CHECKLIST

You earned every one of these. The question is whether you're claiming them.

1. ☐ I am enrolled in VA healthcare. I have a primary care provider through the VA system, and I know how to access care when I need it.
2. ☐ I have filed a disability compensation claim. If I have service-connected conditions — injuries, illnesses, mental health conditions — I have filed, or I have a specific reason I have chosen not to.
3. ☐ I know my current disability rating. If I have one, I know the percentage and the monthly compensation amount. If I don't, I know why.
4. ☐ I have reviewed my rating in the last 2 years. If my conditions have worsened, or if I have conditions that were not included in the original claim, I have filed an increase or a new claim.
5. ☐ I have looked into Vocational Rehabilitation and Employment (VR&E / Chapter 31) as an alternative or supplement to the GI Bill — especially if I have a service-connected disability. I know what it covers and whether I'm eligible.
6. ☐ If I am using the GI Bill (Chapter 33 or Chapter 30), I know my remaining entitlement — to the month and day. I have a plan for how to use it before it expires.
7. ☐ I have investigated the VA home loan guarantee benefit. I know what it is, whether I'm eligible, how many times I can use it, and what the process looks like.
8. ☐ I have VA life insurance through VGLI or SGLI conversion. I know my coverage amount and my monthly premium. I have not let this lapse.

9. [] I know about Chapter 35 (Dependents' Educational Assistance) — if I am 100% P&T disabled, my dependents may be eligible for education benefits. If this applies to me, I have investigated it.

10. [] I have a Veterans Service Officer (VSO) or VA-accredited claims agent I can contact for help with claims — or I know how to find one for free. I am not navigating the VA system entirely alone.

AREA 7: RELATIONSHIPS CHECKLIST

The military gave you a built-in tribe. Civilian life did not. This section assesses the health of your relationships and the support structure around you.

1. [] I have told the people closest to me — my spouse, partner, family — something real about how transition has actually been for me. Not the sanitized version. Something honest.

2. [] If I have a spouse or partner, we have had at least one serious conversation about what the transition has been like for both of us — what's changed, what's been hard, what we both need.

3. [] I have at least one close friendship outside the military — a person I am genuinely close to who did not serve, who knows me well, and who I can call on.

4. [] I have at least one veteran friend who I talk to honestly. Not a drinking buddy. Someone who is building their life and who is part of my accountability structure.

5. [] I have repaired or made an attempt to repair a significant relationship that took damage during my service — from deployment, from distance, from the way service changes a person.

6. [] If I have children, I am actively present — not just physically in the house, but engaged. I have specific time with my children that is uninterrupted and intentional.

7. [] I have identified toxic or draining relationships in my life — people who are consuming energy without contributing to my rebuild — and I have made conscious decisions about those relationships.

8. [] I have asked for help when I needed it in the last 6 months. Not struggled silently. Actually asked.

9. [] I know the difference between being self-sufficient and being isolated. I am not confusing strength with not needing anyone. I have people and I use them.

10. [] I have contributed to someone else's success or wellbeing in the last 30 days — not a grand gesture, just an act of genuine investment in another person's life. I am not only in receive mode.

AREA 8: OWNERSHIP MINDSET CHECKLIST

Are you building a life, or waiting for one to happen? This section is about radical ownership of your post-service reality.

1. ☐ I have written down — on paper, not just in my head — what I want my life to look like in 1 year, 3 years, and 5 years. I have specifics, not just categories.
2. ☐ When something in my life is not working, my first response is to examine what I can change — not to explain why the situation is someone else's fault or beyond my control.
3. ☐ I have a 90-day written plan with specific, measurable goals and weekly action steps. Not a resolution. A plan.
4. ☐ I am taking one new risk or pursuing one new initiative right now — something that could fail, something with stakes, something I care about. I am not playing it safe because safe has stopped feeling like enough.
5. ☐ I have identified the one thing I keep procrastinating on — the phone call I haven't made, the claim I haven't filed, the conversation I've been avoiding — and I have put it on my calendar with a date.
6. ☐ I am not waiting to feel motivated before I take action. I act on schedule. I use the discipline I have. I know that motivation follows action, not the other way around.
7. ☐ I invest in my own development. Books, courses, coaching, mentorship, community — something. I am not relying on employers or institutions to develop me. I am developing myself.
8. ☐ I hold myself accountable with metrics. Not just effort, not just intentions — outcomes. I measure something. I know whether I am moving forward or standing still.
9. ☐ I know the difference between a circumstance and a choice. I can identify clearly which parts of my current situation are things that happened to me and which parts are choices I have made — even the hard ones to acknowledge.
10. ☐ I am building something. Not surviving. Not waiting. Building. I can name what it is, describe the next step, and tell you why it matters to me.

HOW TO READ YOUR RESULTS

Count your [X] marks across all 8 areas.

- **64–80 [X]:** You are in active rebuild mode. You have solid foundations across most areas. The gaps you have are specific and fixable. Use the action items attached to your [] items and execute.
- **40–63 [X]:** You have real strengths and real gaps. You are functioning but you know you're leaving capability on the table. You need a system to address the [] items in a structured way — not all at once, but in a sequence.
- **20–39 [X]:** You are in early transition. Multiple foundational areas need work. This is not a crisis — this is an honest starting point. The most important thing you can do right now is get into a structured program that addresses all of these areas systematically, with support.
- **Under 20 [X]:** You are still in the drift phase. The good news is that you completed this checklist, which means you are ready to be honest — and that is the prerequisite for everything. Pick the area with the most items checked and start there. Then get help.

The areas with the most [] marks are your priority order.

This is not a score to feel good or bad about. It is intelligence. Use it like intel.

SECTION 3: NEXT STEPS COPY

You just did something most veterans don't do.

You sat down, answered 80 honest questions, and looked clearly at where your transition actually stands — not where you wish it stood, not where you tell people it stands, but where it actually is. That kind of honesty is uncomfortable. And it's also the only place a real rebuild can start.

The [] marks on your checklist are not failures. They are gaps. And gaps can be closed — with the right system, the right support, and the decision to stop white-knuckling it alone.

That's what MISSION REBUILD™ was built for.

MISSION REBUILD™ is a 12-week operational course for veterans in transition that covers every area of this checklist — in depth, in sequence, with accountability built in. Identity. Discipline. Finances. VA Benefits. Career. Real estate. Mental resilience. Relationships. Ownership.

Not a mindset course. Not a LinkedIn tutorial. A complete system, built by a veteran who went through everything on this checklist and built the program he needed and never had.

Here's what the next step looks like:

If you have 8 or fewer [] marks, MISSION REBUILD™ will help you close the specific gaps that are keeping you from operating at your ceiling.

If you have 9–40 [] marks, MISSION REBUILD™ is the structured program you need to address multiple areas systematically — without overwhelming yourself or losing momentum.

If you have more than 40 [] marks, MISSION REBUILD™ is the framework that will turn scattered effort into directed progress — week by week, area by area, until the rebuild is real.

Wherever you are: there is a next step. And you are not meant to take it alone.

[LEARN MORE ABOUT MISSION REBUILD™ — CLAIM YOUR SPOT]

The checklist told you where you are. The program gives you the path.

Built by a veteran. For veterans. No corporate speak. No fake motivation. Just the system.

[COURSE WEBSITE / ENROLLMENT LINK]

MISSION REBUILD™ is not affiliated with the Department of Veterans Affairs or any government agency. All VA benefit information is educational. Consult a VSO or VA-accredited claims agent for individualized claims assistance. If you are in crisis, contact the Veterans Crisis Line: dial 988 and press 1.